



# VPNs, Proxies and Private DNS

Choose the right privacy tunnel for you

A privacy tool changes who can observe your internet connection; it does not make observation disappear. Connect normally and your internet service provider can see that your connection reached particular internet addresses, while the destination sees your public IP address. Add encrypted DNS, a proxy, VPN or Tor and that visibility shifts to different organisations. The essential question is therefore not, “Am I hidden?” It is, “Who can still see what?”

## Start with HTTPS

HTTPS uses Transport Layer Security to encrypt information

exchanged between your browser and a website and to authenticate the server. After a secure connection is established, request headers and page contents travel inside the encrypted channel. This helps protect passwords, cookies, forms and messages against someone casually reading them on public Wi-Fi.

HTTPS does not hide everything. The destination still knows what you request, and your network can usually see that you connected to an IP address. Account logins, cookies and browser fingerprinting can identify you to the site. HTTPS therefore protects content in transit; it does not provide anonymity.